

AttributeError: module 'pkgutil' has no attribute 'ImpImporter'. Did you mean: 'zipimporter'?

Asked 1 year, 1 month ago Modified 2 months ago Viewed 268k times



192



Earlier I installed some packages like [Matplotlib](#), [NumPy](#), pip (version 23.3.1), wheel (version 0.41.2), etc., and did some programming with those. I used the command `C:\Users\UserName>pip list` to find the list of packages that I have installed, and I am using Python 3.12.0 (by employing code `C:\Users\UserName>py -V`).

I need to use [pyspedas](#) to analyse some data. I am following the instruction that that I received from site to install the package, with a variation (I am not sure whether it matters or not: I am using `py`, instead of `python`). The commands that I use, in the order, are:

```
py -m venv pyspedas
.\pyspedas\Scripts\activate
pip install pyspedas
```

After the last step, I am getting the following output:

```
Collecting pyspedas
  Using cached pyspedas-1.4.47-py3-none-any.whl.metadata (14 kB)
Collecting numpy>=1.19.5 (from pyspedas)
  Using cached numpy-1.26.1-cp312-cp312-win_amd64.whl.metadata (61 kB)
Collecting requests (from pyspedas)
  Using cached requests-2.31.0-py3-none-any.whl.metadata (4.6 kB)
Collecting geopack>=1.0.10 (from pyspedas)
  Using cached geopack-1.0.10-py3-none-any.whl (114 kB)
Collecting cdflib<1.0.0 (from pyspedas)
  Using cached cdflib-0.4.9-py3-none-any.whl (72 kB)
Collecting cdasws>=1.7.24 (from pyspedas)
  Using cached cdasws-1.7.43.tar.gz (21 kB)
Installing build dependencies ... done
Getting requirements to build wheel ... done
Preparing metadata (pyproject.toml) ... done
Collecting netCDF4>=1.6.2 (from pyspedas)
  Using cached netCDF4-1.6.5-cp312-cp312-win_amd64.whl.metadata (1.8 kB)
Collecting pywavelets (from pyspedas)
  Using cached PyWavelets-1.4.1.tar.gz (4.6 MB)
Installing build dependencies ... done
Getting requirements to build wheel ... error
error: subprocess-exited-with-error

× Getting requirements to build wheel did not run successfully.
| exit code: 1
└─> [33 lines of output]
      Traceback (most recent call last):
        File "C:\Users\UserName\pyspedas\Lib\site-
packages\pip\_vendor\pyproject_hooks\_in_process\_in_process.py", line 353, in
<module>
          main()
```

```

File "C:\Users\UserName\pyspedas\Lib\site-
packages\pip\_vendor\pyproject_hooks\_in_process\_in_process.py", line 335, in
main
    json_out['return_val'] = hook(**hook_input['kwargs'])
                                ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
File "C:\Users\UserName\pyspedas\Lib\site-
packages\pip\_vendor\pyproject_hooks\_in_process\_in_process.py", line 112, in
get_requires_for_build_wheel
    backend = _build_backend()
                ^^^^^^^^^^^^^
File "C:\Users\UserName\pyspedas\Lib\site-
packages\pip\_vendor\pyproject_hooks\_in_process\_in_process.py", line 77, in
_build_backend
    obj = import_module(mod_path)
            ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
File
"C:\Users\UserName\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python312\Lib\importlib\__init__.py"
line 90, in import_module
    return _bootstrap._gcd_import(name[level:], package, level)
            ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 1381, in _gcd_import
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 1354, in _find_and_load
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 1304, in
_find_and_load_unlocked
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 488, in
_call_with_frames_removed
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 1381, in _gcd_import
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 1354, in _find_and_load
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 1325, in
_find_and_load_unlocked
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 929, in _load_unlocked
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap_external>", line 994, in exec_module
File "<frozen importlib._bootstrap>", line 488, in
_call_with_frames_removed
File "C:\Users\UserName\AppData\Local\Temp\pip-build-env-
_lgbq70y\overlay\Lib\site-packages\setuptools\__init__.py", line 16, in <module>
    import setuptools.version
File "C:\Users\UserName\AppData\Local\Temp\pip-build-env-
_lgbq70y\overlay\Lib\site-packages\setuptools\version.py", line 1, in <module>
    import pkg_resources
File "C:\Users\UserName\AppData\Local\Temp\pip-build-env-
_lgbq70y\overlay\Lib\site-packages\pkg_resources\__init__.py", line 2191, in
<module>
    register_finder(pkgutil.ImpImporter, find_on_path)
                                ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
AttributeError: module 'pkgutil' has no attribute 'ImpImporter'. Did you
mean: 'zipimporter'?
[end of output]

```

note: This error originates from a subprocess, and is likely not a problem with pip.

error: subprocess-exited-with-error

× Getting requirements to build wheel did not run successfully.

| exit code: 1

↳ See above for output.

note: This error originates from a subprocess, and is likely not a problem with pip.

After little bit of googling, I came to know that this issues was reported at multiple places, but none for this package. I did install wheel in the new environment as mentioned in the answer [here](#), but the problem still persists.

Instead of setting up a virtual environment, I simply executed the command `py -m pip install pyspedas`. But I am still getting the error.

What I could gather is that the program has an issue with

```
Collecting pywavelets (from pyspedas)
  Using cached PyWavelets-1.4.1.tar.gz (4.6 MB)
  Installing build dependencies ... done
```

I am using [IDLE](#) in Windows 11.

`python` `python-3.x` `numpy` `pip`

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edited Sep 4 at 0:40

asked Oct 26, 2023 at 6:22



Free Palestine

25.8k 48 106 143



sreeraj t

2,209 2 15 19

8 Answers

Sorted by: Highest score (default)



Due to the removal of the long-deprecated `pkgutil.ImpImporter` class, the `pip` command may not work for Python 3.12.

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You just have to manually install pip for Python 3.12



```
python -m ensurepip --upgrade
python -m pip install --upgrade setuptools
python -m pip install <module>
```

In your virtual environment:

```
pip install --upgrade setuptools
```

Python comes with an `ensurepip`, which can install pip in a Python environment.

<https://pip.pypa.io/en/stable/installation/>

On **Linux/macOS** terminal:

```
python -m ensurepip --upgrade
```

On **Windows**:

```
py -m ensurepip --upgrade
```

also, make sure to upgrade pip:

```
py -m pip install --upgrade pip
```

To install numpy on Python 3.12, you must use numpy version 1.26.4

```
pip install numpy==1.26.4
```

<https://github.com/numpy/numpy/issues/23808#issuecomment-1722440746>

for Ubuntu

```
sudo apt install python3.12-dev
```

or

```
python3.12 -m pip install --upgrade setuptools
```

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edited Jul 25 at 6:34

answered Oct 26, 2023 at 6:32



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25.8k 48 106 143

Thanks for the response. I executed the commands `C:\Users\UserName>pip -V` & `C:\Users\UserName>py -m ensurepip --upgrade`, whose response was `pip 23.3.1` from `C:\Users\UserName\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python312\Lib\site-packages\pip` (python 3.12) and Looking in links: `c:\Users\UserName\AppData\Local\Temp\tmp23bcewt`
Requirement already satisfied: pip in `c:\users\UserName\appdata\local\programs\python\python312\lib\site-packages` (23.3.1).
But the problem still persists. — [sreeraj t](#) Oct 26, 2023 at 8:49

- 1 I sincerely appreciate all your help. I executed the commands in the following order: `pip install --upgrade virtualenv --> virtualenv venv123 --python=python3.12 -->`

venv123\Scripts\activate.bat --> pip install pyspedas . But still persists. Do you think that installing an older version will solve the issue? – [sreeraj t](#) Oct 26, 2023 at 11:09

2 python3.12 -m pip install --upgrade setuptools solved it for me, Ubuntu 22.04. – [Leo77](#) Dec 28, 2023 at 10:38

33 how is python still so broken? i spend 90% of my time chasing down stuff like this in any one of the 15 package managers supposedly there to make my life easier. Just an awful experience trying to use any of this freeware garbage – [RichyRoo](#) Mar 3 at 22:58

1 Adding `setuptools` to the `Pipfile` seemed to fix this on one occasion. – [andrewdotn](#) Mar 20 at 15:51

My problem was listing older version of [NumPy](#) in requirements.txt, which may be obvious problem, but for people stuck with this:

33

Check for the [newer versions of NumPy](#). I needed to list it as:

`numpy~1.26.4`



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edited Apr 19 at 2:26



[Peter Mortensen](#)

31.6k 22 109 133

answered Mar 29 at 9:52



[BanikPyco](#)

783 9 12

2 this is what worked for 3.12.xx – [user2290820](#) May 12 at 15:03

Thank you! worked for me as well (3.12.3) – [Irgendniemand](#) May 16 at 13:54

This fixed it for me - if you're trying to install numpy on Python 3.12, you must use v1.26.0+ github.com/numpy/numpy/issues/23808 – [jon_two](#) May 24 at 16:00

The most relevant answer, indeed. – [Julio S.](#) Jun 11 at 12:16

Python has removed some previously deprecated symbols in the `importlib`. This is mentioned in the [Python 3.12 release notes](#)

12

Many previously deprecated cleanups in `importlib` have now been completed:

...

- `importlib.abc.Finder`, `pkgutil.ImpImporter`, and `pkgutil.ImpLoader` have been removed. (Contributed by Barry Warsaw in [gh-98040](#).)

The error message means that something tries to use the removed `pkgutil.ImpImporter` during package install. This something may be either `pip`, `setuptools`, or the `setup.py` install script in the

package itself. Looking at the stacktrace, upgrading `setuptools` (inside virtual environment if you use virtual environment) should fix this.

Also note this related release notes entry in 3.12

[gh-95299](#): Do not pre-install setuptools in virtual environments created with venv. This means that `distutils`, `setuptools`, `pkg_resources`, and `easy_install` will no longer be available by default; to access these run `pip install setuptools` in the activated virtual environment.

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edited Feb 6 at 14:22

answered Nov 11, 2023 at 15:06



[user7610](#)

28.5k 17 142 164



As others have commented, the issue is Python 3.12 being incompatible with the version of pip.

7

My initial solution was:



```
python -m ensurepip --upgrade
pip3.12 install ...
```



where ... was the package wanting to be installed.

This was an incomplete solution as my IDE ([PyCharm](#)) was still throwing the same error opening other files.

The below code upgraded the pip version globally

```
py -m pip install --upgrade pip
```

I then followed this with refreshing my IDE. This is currently working.

Further update: I have resorted to using a conda environment.

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edited Jul 3 at 11:03

answered Mar 28 at 23:38



[Free Palestine](#)

25.8k 48 106 143



[rd5201](#)

116 1 4



What did work for me on [Ubuntu 22.04](#) (Jammy Jellyfish) was installing the development header files for Python 3.12.

5

```
sudo apt install python3.12-dev
```



After that, everything went well.



Everything else didn't work for me, because upgrading any package on existing Python 3.12 virtual environment would result into the same error. After installing the `python3.12-dev` both `pip` and `setuptools` were fresh.

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edited Jan 7 at 4:49

answered Nov 19, 2023 at 21:31



Peter Mortensen

31.6k 22 109 133



Artur Barseghyan

14k 5 55 46



5

I recently had this same issue as I only just installed 3.12 on a [venv](#) and encountered the issue. Some of the suggestions above worked for me. For information, I'm using Windows and [PyCharm](#) for my development.



Every time I tried to install a package on this fresh 3.12 installation, I got the same attribute error. To fix it, I did the following.



From the terminal inside PyCharm:

```
python -m ensurepip --upgrade
python -m pip install --upgrade setuptools
python -m pip install <module>
```

One thing I've noticed over previous versions is that, at least on however mine is set up, the `python -m` as a prefix to `pip` is now mandatory, whereas before I could just go straight to a `pip install <module>` command. This may be down to something different in my setup or it could be due to a force from 3.12...

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edited Apr 19 at 2:17

answered Mar 17 at 12:44



Peter Mortensen

31.6k 22 109 133



Neodreadlord

92 1 9

`python -m ensurepip --upgrade` work as the only solution that worked. – [Son Goku ssj4](#) Apr 14 at 16:29

`python -m ensurepip --upgrade` is already mentioned in the accepted answer <https://stackoverflow.com/a/77364602/13086128> – [Free Palestine](#) Apr 25 at 13:09



The easiest solution for me here was to **use Python 3.10** still. The project was written using this version of Python and before this issue there was at least another one I had to solve.

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answered Aug 6 at 11:27

[havryliuk](#)**195** 1 12

I recently had this same issue as I only just installed 3.12. This solution worked for me. Because I have an old version of pandas in the dependencies package, I only had to update the Pandas version because it was not compatible with Python 3.12, and everything worked smoothly

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answered Mar 21 at 9:56

[la-Quica](#)**1**

1 in my case , just upgrade `numpy` to `1.26.4` . other solvations not work – [hn_tired](#) May 5 at 19:16



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